

What to Expect and How to Prepare

A plain walkthrough of surgery day.

Here's what a typical day looks like. Your surgeon's office will confirm the specifics for you.



BEFORE YOUR SURGERY

- ☐ Attend your pre-op appointment — this is where your surgeon confirms your lens and measurements
- ☐ Arrange a ride home — you won't be able to drive yourself afterward
- ☐ Plan to take it easy for the rest of the day
- ☐ Wear comfortable, loose-fitting clothing, and skip lotion, makeup, or jewelry near your eyes
- ☐ Bring sunglasses — your eyes may be sensitive to light afterward
- ☐ Ask your surgeon's office for any instructions specific to you

DAY OF SURGERY

1

Arrival

Check in and get settled

2

Prep

Drops, monitoring, anesthesia

3

Procedure

10–15 min, mild pressure not pain

4

Recovery room

Brief rest and monitoring

5

Discharge

Ride home, first instructions

AFTER YOUR SURGERY

ONE EYE AT A TIME

Most cataract surgery is done one eye at a time — one eye, a recovery period, then the other. This lets each eye heal on its own timeline.

THE FIRST 24–48 HOURS

- ☐ Wear the protective shield, especially while sleeping
- ☐ Avoid rubbing or pressing on your eye
- ☐ Keep water out of your eye when washing your face or showering
- ☐ Skip strenuous activity, swimming, and hot tubs for now

RECOVERY, IN GENERAL

- ☐ Light activity resumes within a day or two
- ☐ Driving resumes once your surgeon confirms
- ☐ Full healing continues over several weeks

WHEN TO CALL YOUR SURGEON

- ☐ Sudden vision loss, or a sudden increase in floaters or flashes
- ☐ Pain that gets worse instead of better
- ☐ Increasing redness, swelling, or discharge

EYE DROPS, IN GENERAL

You'll likely use anti-inflammatory and antibiotic drops for several weeks to support healing and help prevent infection. Your surgeon's office will give you the exact routine to follow.

YOUR GLASSES PRESCRIPTION

Vision can fluctuate while your eye heals, so any new glasses prescription usually waits until healing is complete — often a few weeks after surgery.

If you have an advanced-technology lens, your brain may take some time — weeks to months — adjusting to the new visual input. Halos or glare, if present, often lessen as this adaptation happens.

Still have questions specific to you?

The IOL ClarityIQ Session covers exactly this — at your pace, in your own words.

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